

► HECKLER AND KOCH
VP70M

Date 1970s

Origin Germany

Barrel 4½in (11.6cm)

Caliber 9mm Parabellum

The VP70M, the first pistol to make extensive use of plastic, was an attempt to produce a fully automatic handgun, although limited to firing three-round bursts. The mechanism that controlled this was housed in the detachable butt; when it was removed, the pistol reverted to normal semiautomatic operation.



FULL VIEW



External
silencer

Enclosed
hammer

Burst-fire
selector

Push-button
safety catch

Butt houses
18-round magazine

Fiber-reinforced
polymer butt



Slide

Slide stop

► CZ75

Date 1975

Origin Czechoslovakia

Barrel 4¾in (12cm)

Caliber 9mm Parabellum

The CZ75 had several derivatives, such as the CZ97 in .45in caliber and the CZ75 P-07 featuring a polymer frame rather than a steel one. These models quickly established reputations for reliability, and they were adopted by a number of military and police forces.



Barrel (visible)

Cutaway slide top

Muzzle

Recurved trigger
guard to facilitate
two-handed grip

Butt houses
detachable
13-round box
magazine

► BERETTA MODEL 92FS

Date 1976

Origin Italy

Barrel 4¾in (10.9cm)

Caliber 9mm Parabellum

The Beretta 92 was chosen as the US military's official sidearm to replace the Colt M1911A1 (see p.169) in the 1980s. Its frame was forged from aluminum to reduce weight. The slide top was cut away to allow single rounds to be loaded manually.